NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

**KEY TOPIC 2** CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1919–1933

# Key Topic 2: Hitler's Rise to Power, 1919–33

*Early NSDAP, Munich Putsch, Lean Years, Great Depression & Appointment as Chancellor*



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • JULY 1926

**Adolf Hitler Addresses the 2nd National Socialist Party Rally in Weimar**

Hitler reviewing paramilitary SA stormtroopers at the 1926 Weimar Party Congress following the lifting of the party ban. Accession Shelfmark BA 183-1987-0703-506.

**PEARSON EDEXCEL** OPTION 31 • KEY TOPIC 2 CONTENT — OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

## 1 Early Development of the Nazi Party, 1920–22

- Hitler's early career: joining the German Workers' Party and setting up the Nazi Party, 1919–20.
- The Twenty-Five Point Programme. The role of the SA.

## 2 The Munich Putsch and the Nazi Party, 1923–28

- The reasons for, events and consequences of the **Munich Putsch**; **Mein Kampf**.
- Reasons for limited support for the Nazi Party, 1924–28. Party reorganisation, including the Bamberg Conference of 1926.

## 3 The Growth in Support for the Nazis, 1929–32

- The growth of unemployment – its causes and impact. The growth of support for the Communist Party.
- Reasons for the growth in support for the Nazi Party, including the appeal of Hitler and the Nazis, the effects of propaganda and the work of the SA.

## 4 How Hitler Became Chancellor, 1932–33

- The Presidential and Reichstag elections of 1932; reasons for Hitler becoming Chancellor in 1933, including the roles of Hindenburg and von Papen.

## LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

**Instructions:** As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

### FEB 1920 • The 25-Point Programme & Foundation of NSDAP

**KEY TOPIC 2.1**

Hitler and Anton Drexler publish the 25-Point Programme in Munich. It demands the abolition of Versailles, creation of a Greater Germany, and denial of German citizenship to Jews.

### 8–9 NOV 1923 • The Munich Putsch (Beer Hall Putsch) Crushed

**KEY TOPIC 2.1**

Hitler and General Ludendorff attempt to seize power in Munich with 2,000 armed SA men. The Bavarian police fire on the marchers at the Odeonsplatz, killing 16 Nazis. Hitler is arrested and tried for high treason.

### FEB 1926 • The Bamberg Conference Secures the Führerprinzip

**KEY TOPIC 2.2**

Hitler summons party leaders to Bamberg. He crushes the northern socialist wing led by Gregor Strasser, securing unchallenged authority as supreme Führer and focusing on rural, anti-communist voters.



*"Anton Drexler founded the DAP; Hitler joined as member 555 and stole the entire show."*

## LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

**Instructions:** Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

### 29 OCT 1929 • Wall Street Crash Triggers the Great Depression

**KEY TOPIC 2.3**

The US stock market collapses; American banks immediately call in their short-term loans to Germany. German factories close, banks fail, and unemployment surges from 1.3 million to over 6 million.

### JUL 1932 • NSDAP Becomes Largest Party in the Reichstag

**KEY TOPIC 2.3**

Amidst mass poverty and street clashes, the Nazis win 230 seats (37.3% of the vote) in the July 1932 election. Hitler demands the Chancellorship, but President von Hindenburg refuses to appoint the "Bohemian corporal".

### 30 JAN 1933 • Hitler Appointed Chancellor via Backstairs Intrigue

**KEY TOPIC 2.4**

Convinced by Franz von Papen that Hitler can be controlled in a coalition with only three Nazi ministers, President Hindenburg reluctantly appoints Adolf Hitler as Chancellor of Germany.

# Why did the Nazi Party grow from an obscure fringe group into a notorious political force in Bavaria by 1922?

AUDIO • QUIZ

## 1 • How did military surveillance lead directly to party membership?

- Anton Drexler DAP
- Adolf Hitler joins (1919)
- Munich beer-cellar meetings

## 2 • How did the 25-Point Programme combine nationalist and socialist appeals?

- 25-Point NSDAP Programme
- Versailles Treaty repudiation
- Anti-Semitic citizenship exclusion

## 3 • Why was visual branding crucial for attracting working-class recruits?

- NSDAP party rebranding
- Swastika party emblem
- Völkischer Beobachter newspaper

## 4 • How did personal oratory secure complete dominance over party rivals?

- Führerprinzip absolute leadership
- Resignation ultimatum (Jul 1921)
- Anton Drexler sidelined

## 5 • What role did organized paramilitary violence play in protecting meetings?

- Sturmabteilung (SA) Brownshirts
- Ernst Röhm leadership
- Rival party intimidation



*"The SA: Brownshirted streetfighters who protected Nazi meetings and beat up rival Communists."*

## Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [ / 12 ]

**Explain why the Nazi Party (NSDAP) developed rapidly in the years 1920–1922. [12 marks]**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **You may use in your answer:** | • Hitler's personal oratory and speeches | • The creation of the SA (Sturmabteilung) | ***(You must also use information of your own.)*** |

**ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:** *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

***Write your response in the space provided below:***

*(Response continues on Page 6)*

**TIMELINE MISSION** Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 2.1). In the drawing box, sketch a Munich beer hall meeting with stormtroopers guarding the doors and Hitler speaking from a table. Annotate how theatrical oratory and violence built party support. [ ] Done

*Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):*

**QUESTION 1 PRACTICE** **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** 4 MARKS • 5 MINS Score: [ / 4 ]

**Give two things you can infer from Source A about Adolf Hitler's speechmaking in Munich beer halls in 1921.**

**SOURCE A** *From the memoirs of a Munich resident who attended a Nazi rally in the Hofbräuhaus, November 1921.*

*"The hall was packed to suffocating point with workers, soldiers, and students. When Hitler stepped forward, dead silence fell. He began hoarsely, but within minutes his voice rose to a fanatical roar, gesticulating wildly. He named the guilty politicians who signed the Armistice, and the crowd jumped on chairs screaming approval."*

**(i) What I can infer:** *[1 mark]*

**Details in SOURCE A that tell me this:** *[1 mark]*

**(ii) What I can infer:** *[1 mark]*

**Details in SOURCE A that tell me this:** *[1 mark]*

# Why did the Munich Putsch fail in 1923, and how did Hitler reorganise the Nazi Party during the Lean Years?

AUDIO • QUIZ

## 1 • How did the armed coup attempt to overthrow the Bavarian state?

- Bürgerbräukeller Beer Hall
- General Erich Ludendorff
- Failed Munich march (16 dead)

## 2 • Why did the Bavarian police crush the march instead of defecting?

- Munich treason trial
- Hitler courtroom propaganda
- Lenient five-year sentence

## 3 • How did the trial transform a humiliating defeat into a propaganda triumph?

- Landsberg Fortress detention
- Mein Kampf treatise
- Lebensraum territorial expansion

## 4 • Why did the Führer demand absolute obedience and legal election tactics?

- Legal democratic pathway
- 1926 Bamberg Conference
- Party discipline consolidated

## 5 • Why did economic stability make radical nationalist propaganda ineffective?

- 1928 Reichstag election (2.6%)
- Twelve parliamentary seats
- Gauleiter nationwide apparatus

## Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [ / 12 ]

**Explain why the Nazi Party changed its strategy during the 'Lean Years' (1924–1929). [12 marks]**

**You may use in your answer:** • The failure of the Munich Putsch (1923) • The Bamberg Conference (1926) ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

**ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:** *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

***Write your response in the space provided below:***

*(Response continues on Page 9)*

**TIMELINE MISSION** Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 2.2). In the drawing box, sketch Hitler in his Landsberg cell dictating Mein Kampf alongside a ballot box. Annotate why Hitler abandoned violent armed coups in favor of democratic elections. [ ] Done

*Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):*

**QUESTION 1 PRACTICE** **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE B** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [ / 4 ]**

**Give two things you can infer from Source B about the Munich Putsch trial in 1924.**

**SOURCE B** *From an article in a Munich newspaper reporting on Hitler's trial for high treason, March 1924.*

*"The judges listened in respectful silence as Hitler spoke for four hours without interruption. He boldly admitted trying to overthrow the Berlin government, claiming he acted as a patriot to save Germany from Marxism. The court seemed more like a political platform for the defendant than a hall of justice."*

**(i) What I can infer:** *[1 mark]*

**Details in SOURCE B that tell me this:** *[1 mark]*

**(ii) What I can infer:** *[1 mark]*

**Details in SOURCE B that tell me this:** *[1 mark]*

# Why did support for the Nazi Party surge dramatically following the Wall Street Crash of 1929?

AUDIO • QUIZ

## 1 • How did the American stock crash shatter Germany's banking system?

- Wall Street Crash (1929)
- US bank loans recalled
- German financial collapse

## 2 • Why did Brüning's austerity policies deepen economic misery?

- 6 million unemployed
- Heinrich Brüning deflation
- Hunger Chancellor cuts

## 3 • How did fear of a Communist revolution drive middle-class voters toward the Nazis?

- Joseph Goebbels propaganda
- 'Hitler over Germany' flights
- Radio & mass posters

## 4 • What innovative propaganda methods created an impression of dynamic national movement?

- Mittelstand small-business appeal
- Fear of Communist revolution
- Industrialist financial backing

## 5 • Why did the Nazis become the largest party yet remain excluded from power?

- July 1932 election (37.3%)
- 230 Reichstag seats
- Largest parliamentary party



*"Wall Street Crash Oct 1929: America called in its loans; Germany's economic house of cards collapsed."*

## Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [ / 12 ]

**Explain why support for the Nazi Party increased in the years 1929–1932. [12 marks]**

**You may use in your answer:** • The Wall Street Crash and mass unemployment • Nazi propaganda under Joseph Goebbels *(You must also use information of your own.)*

**ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:** *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

***Write your response in the space provided below:***

*(Response continues on Page 12)*

**TIMELINE MISSION** Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 2.3). In the drawing box, sketch an unemployed worker in soup kitchen queues alongside a Nazi poster promising "Work and Bread". Annotate why desperate voters abandoned moderate democracy for radical extremes. [ ] Done

*Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):*

**QUESTION 1 PRACTICE** **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE C** 4 MARKS • 5 MINS Score: [ / 4 ]

**Give two things you can infer from Source C about why ordinary Germans turned to the Nazi Party during the Great Depression.**

**SOURCE C** *From a diary entry by a middle-class schoolteacher in Hamburg, May 1932.*

*"Our savings are completely gone, and my husband's small pension has been cut in half by government decrees. Yesterday we stood in the soup queue behind former factory managers and clerks in frayed collars. The National Socialists held a rally in the square: their speakers did not offer vague compromises, but promised work, bread, and national pride. Desperate men clapped until their hands bled."*

**(i) What I can infer:** *[1 mark]*

**Details in SOURCE C that tell me this:** *[1 mark]*

**(ii) What I can infer:** *[1 mark]*

**Details in SOURCE C that tell me this:** *[1 mark]*

# Why was Adolf Hitler appointed Chancellor of Germany on 30 January 1933?

AUDIO • QUIZ

## 1 • Why did the November 1932 election suggest Nazi momentum was fading?

- Brüning dismissal (May 1932)
- Article 48 rule failure
- President Hindenburg intervention

## 2 • Why did Schleicher's policies alienate powerful conservative barons?

- Franz von Papen chancellor
- 'Cabinet of Barons'
- November election seat decline

## 3 • How did Papen's personal rivalry with Schleicher lead to political collusion?

- General Kurt von Schleicher
- Cabinet intrigue crisis
- Failure to split Nazis

## 4 • Why did conservative elites believe they could control and manipulate Hitler?

- Von Papen backroom intrigue
- Hindenburg appointment persuaded
- 'Hitler boxed in' belief

## 5 • How did the appointment mark both legal transition and triumphant celebration?

- 30 January 1933
- Hitler sworn chancellor
- Torchlight victory parades

## Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [ / 12 ]

**Explain why Adolf Hitler was appointed Chancellor of Germany in January 1933. [12 marks]**

**You may use in your answer:** • The political intrigue of Franz von Papen • The November 1932 election results *(You must also use information of your own.)*

**ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:** *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

***Write your response in the space provided below:***

*(Response continues on Page 15)*

**TIMELINE MISSION** Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 2.4). In the drawing box, sketch Franz von Papen whispering into aged President Hindenburg's ear as Hitler shakes hands on 30 January 1933. Annotate Papen's fateful boast: "In two months we will have pushed him into a corner!" [ ] Done



*"November 1932 Setback: Nazi vote dropped to 196 seats; the party was bankrupt and deeply demoralised."*

*Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):*

**QUESTION 1 PRACTICE** **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE D** 4 MARKS • 5 MINS Score: [ / 4 ]

**Give two things you can infer from Source D about Franz von Papen's scheme to appoint Hitler as Chancellor.**

**SOURCE D** *From the memoirs of a German diplomat in Berlin, recalling events in January 1933.*

*"Papen was utterly convinced he had outsmarted everyone. He assured President Hindenburg that Hitler would merely be a decorative figurehead in the cabinet, surrounded by experienced conservative ministers who held all key portfolios. Papen laughed off our warnings, declaring with absolute self-assurance that within two months they would have pushed Hitler so far into a corner that he would squeal."*

**(i) What I can infer:** *[1 mark]*

**Details in SOURCE D that tell me this:** *[1 mark]*

**(ii) What I can infer:** *[1 mark]*

**Details in SOURCE D that tell me this:** *[1 mark]*

# Question 3(a): Source Utility [8 marks • 12 mins]

**SOURCE B**

**Presidential Emergency Decree under Article 48, Berlin, December 1931**

*From an official emergency decree signed by President Paul von Hindenburg and Chancellor Heinrich Brüning, published in the German legal gazette, December 1931.*

"On the basis of Article 48 of the Reich Constitution, the following is decreed to secure the economy and finances: All public sector wages and salaries are reduced by ten percent. Unemployment relief payments are strictly curtailed. Prices of essential goods are reduced by decree." By ruling through presidential decree rather than parliament, Chancellor Brüning became known as the 'Hunger Chancellor', driving millions of desperate Germans towards radical political parties.

**SOURCE C**

**Contemporary photograph of Nazi SA Stormtroopers, Berlin, July 1932**



*From a press photograph taken during the July 1932 Reichstag election campaign in Berlin. It shows uniformed SA stormtroopers parading in formation with swastika flags.*

By July 1932, the SA numbered over 400,000 men—four times the size of the regular German Army. Their disciplined parades, martial brass bands, and street brawls with the Communist Rotfrontkämpferbund presented an image of dynamic youth, strength, and order to middle-class voters terrified of Bolshevik revolution during the Great Depression.

**Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the reasons for the growth in support for the Nazi Party in the years 1929–1932? [8 marks]**

**Assessment Formula:** Evaluate Content + Provenance (Author, Motive, Date) with contextual knowledge for Source B, then Source C.

**Evaluate Source B (Content & Provenance on parliamentary paralysis, wage cuts, and Brüning's austerity):**

*(Source C evaluation continues on Page 17)*

**QUESTION 3(A) CONTINUED: EVALUATE SOURCE C (CONTENT & PROVENANCE ON SA DISCIPLINE, PARAMILITARY APPEAL, AND ANTI-COMMUNIST STRENGTH):** **Score: [ / 8 ]**

**HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS 1 AND 2** **Target: How and why historians differ (AO4)**

**INTERPRETATION 1**

*From an account by historian William Carr, A History of Germany 1815–1990 (1991)*

"The Nazi Party grew into a mass movement primarily because the Great Depression shattered the economic and social foundations of the Weimar Republic. With six million Germans unemployed by 1932, millions of desperate middle-class voters, shopkeepers, and farmers turned to the NSDAP as the only radical alternative to Communism. In a democracy that had collapsed into economic paralysis, it was the despair produced by mass unemployment and Brüning's wage-cutting policies that drove voters in their millions to support Hitler."

**INTERPRETATION 2**

*From an account by historian Richard J. Evans, The Coming of the Third Reich (2003)*

"The rapid growth of Nazi support between 1929 and 1932 cannot be explained solely by economic distress. Other nations suffered mass unemployment without turning to fascism. What set the Nazis apart was their brilliant modern electioneering and Hitler's magnetic personal appeal. Goebbels orchestrated dynamic campaigns using aeroplanes, radio, and mass rallies, while the uniformed SA stormtroopers provided an intoxicating image of discipline and order on the streets. It was Nazi propaganda and paramilitary energy that captivated voters."

**Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the reasons for the growth in support for the Nazi Party in the years 1929–1932. What is the main difference between these views? |4 marks|** **Score: [ / 4 ]**

**Mark Scheme Law:** Identify the fundamental difference in emphasis, then back up each view with direct quotes or specific details from both interpretations.

## Question 3(c): Why Views Differ [4 marks • 5 mins]

**Score: [ / 4 ]**

**Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the reasons for the growth in support for the Nazi Party in the years 1929–1932. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. [4 marks]**

**Examiner Guidance:** AO4 [4 marks]: Explain differing emphasis on economic hardship (Source B) vs propaganda and paramilitary appeal (Source C).

## QUESTION 3(D) ESSAY PLANNING & CRITERIA SETUP

**16 Marks + 4 SPaG = 20 Marks • 25 Mins**

**How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the reasons for the growth in support for the Nazi Party in the years 1929–1932? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. [16 marks + 4 SPaG]**

**Thesis Prompt:** Formulate your sustained thesis: Was the surge in Nazi support between 1929 and 1932 primarily driven by the economic catastrophe of the Depression, or by Hitler's propaganda and the disciplined appeal of the SA?

**Criteria Planning Canvas:** Establish criteria benchmark, map quotes from Int 1 & Int 2, and outline your verdict:

*(Essay continues on Page 19)*

**Level 4 Target (13–16 Marks):** Balanced analysis of both views • Sustained contextual knowledge • Justified criteria-led judgment.

**SPaG: 4/4 MARKS**

## Question 3(d): Evaluative Essay on Historical Interpretations

**AO4: [ / 16 ] | SPaG: [ / 4 ] | Total: [ / 20 ]**

**[16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 20 MARKS • TIMED ESSAY: 25 MINS]**

**How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the reasons for the growth in support for the Nazi Party in the years 1929–1932? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. [16 marks + 4 SPaG]**

*Write your response in the space provided below:*

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Band 4 Criteria Check:** | [ ] Criteria Established | [ ] Both Ints Explored | [ ] Precise Own Knowledge | [ ] Justified Verdict | **Teacher Sign-off:** _____ |

*"Question 3(d): Deliver a justified verdict on whether economic crisis or political intrigue was the decisive catalyst."* **19/20**

# STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 2 TRACKER

Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–1939 (Hitler's Rise to Power, 1919–33)

**PUPIL:** _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

| # | ENQUIRY / ASSESSMENT UNIT | DO NOW (10M) | Q1 INFER (4M) | Q2 EXPLAIN (12M) | MODULE TOTAL |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **KT2.1: Early Development of the Nazi Party, 1920–1922**<br>*"Why did the Nazi Party grow from an obscure fringe group into a notorious political force in Bavaria by 1922?"* | / 10 | / 4 | / 12 | / 26 |
| 2 | **KT2.2: The Munich Putsch and the Lean Years, 1923–1929**<br>*"Why did the Munich Putsch fail in 1923, and how did Hitler reorganise the Nazi Party during the Lean Years?"* | / 10 | / 4 | / 12 | / 26 |
| 3 | **KT2.3: The Growth in Support for the Nazis, 1929–1932**<br>*"Why did support for the Nazi Party surge dramatically following the Wall Street Crash of 1929?"* | / 10 | / 4 | / 12 | / 26 |
| 4 | **KT2.4: How Hitler Became Chancellor, 1932–1933**<br>*"Why was Adolf Hitler appointed Chancellor of Germany on 30 January 1933?"* | / 10 | / 4 | / 12 | / 26 |
| ★ | **Section B Capstone Assessment (pp. 16–19)**<br>*Q3(a) Utility [8m] • Q3(b) Study Views [4m] • Q3(c) Why Differ [4m] • Q3(d) Evaluative Essay [20m]* | Q3(a): / 8 | Q3(b): / 4 | Q3(c): / 4 • Q3(d): / 20 | / 36 |
| **KEY TOPIC 2 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS** | | **Do Now: / 40** | **Q1 Infer: / 16** | **Q2 Cause: / 48** | **/ 140** |

## TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

**WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):**

_____

_____

_____

**EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):**

_____

_____

_____

**Teacher Signature:** _____ **Date:** _____

## DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • 20-QUESTION PRACTICE QUIZZES

Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes

| KT 2.1 | KT 2.2 | KT 2.3 | KT 2.4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| SCAN TO QUIZ | SCAN TO QUIZ | SCAN TO QUIZ | SCAN TO QUIZ |
| **Score: / 20** | **Score: / 20** | **Score: / 20** | **Score: / 20** |